

Date	31 January 2025	Maximum Marks	4 Marks
Team ID	SWTID-2026-5019	Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Design Thinking Collaboration
ServiceNow ETL & Data Integration

PROJECT OVERVIEW & CONTEXT

This micro project focuses on importing structured data from an external spreadsheet into the ServiceNow platform using **Import Sets** and **Transform Maps**. The project simulates an enterprise onboarding scenario where bulk employee rosters received in Excel format must be loaded into an isolated Import Set staging table, mapped accurately to the target sys_user table, transformed with coalesce rules to eliminate duplicates, and audited for complete data integrity.

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Framework: Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcomed, clustered, and evaluated on an Importance vs. Feasibility matrix to turn broad concepts into actionable platform configurations.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration & Problem Framing

PHASE SETUP

Preparation: 10 Minutes

Collaboration: 1 Hour Active Session

Participants: 2–6 Technical Roles

FOCUS PROBLEM STATEMENT (HOW MIGHT WE)

"How might we efficiently and safely import bulk employee spreadsheets into ServiceNow target tables using Import Sets and Transform Maps, eliminating manual entry, preventing duplicate profiles, and guaranteeing 100% data integrity?"

KEY RULES OF BRAINSTORMING

1. DEFER JUDGMENT

Do not criticize any concept during initial ideation; separate creation from critique.

2. GO FOR VOLUME

Generate as many technical alternatives and safeguards as possible within the time box.

3. WILD IDEAS

Encourage creative ETL scripting, staging designs, and validation mechanisms.

4. BUILD ON OTHERS

Connect ingestion staging ideas with transform coalesce rules and audit checkpoints.

5. STAY FOCUSED

Center all ideas on solving Excel-to-ServiceNow data migration accuracy and security.

Ideation Synthesis: Grouping & Prioritization

ServiceNow Transform Maps • From Divergent Ideas to Actionable Engineering

Team ID: SWTID-2026-5019

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing & Thematic Grouping

Clustered across 4 architectural ETL domains

Cluster 1: Ingestion & Staging Isolation

2 Ideas

DEDICATED STAGING TABLE
Create u_imp_employee_data to quarantine raw Excel rows before any live database writes.

PRE-LOAD HEADER INSPECTION
Configure Data Source to parse header row 1 and discard blank trailing spreadsheet columns.

Cluster 2: Field Mapping & Identity

2 Ideas

AUTO MAP MATCHING FIELDS
Leverage native auto-mapping for direct 1:1 schema pairs (First Name, Last Name, Email, Phone).

STRICT COALESCE ON USER ID
Set Coalesce = true on Employee ID to guarantee updates without creating duplicate users.

Cluster 3: Transformation Scripts & Logic

2 Ideas

ONBEFORE DATE FORMATTER
Transform script converting raw spreadsheet strings into standard platform YYYY-MM-DD.

REFERENCE FIELD AUTO-CHOICE
Set 'Create choice' or mapping lookup to populate Department and Location reference sys_ids.

Cluster 4: Audit & Verification Controls

2 Ideas

TRANSFORM HISTORY LOG AUDIT
Inspect completed run logs for skipped, error, and inserted row tallies before release sign-off.

SPOT-CHECK SYS_USER RECORDS
Query active user records post-transform to confirm field parity against source Excel rows.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization (Importance vs. Feasibility Matrix)

Evaluating 8 core concepts for implementation

STRATEGIC BETS

- onBefore Scripts
Normalize date & phone
- Ref Field Resolution
Dept / Manager sys_ids

QUICK WINS (DO FIRST)

- Coalesce on User ID
No duplicate user profiles
- Import Set Staging
Quarantine
- Auto-Map Fields
Instant 1:1 mapping

DEPRIORITIZE

- Custom Portal UI
Out-of-scope overhead

INCREMENTAL / NICE-TO-HAVE

- Transform Log Audit
Tally inserts vs skipped

1. QUICK WINS (IMMEDIATE IMPLEMENTATION)

HIGH IMP • HIGH FEAS

- COALESCE ON UNIQUE KEY:**
Ensure Employee ID is marked coalesce to prevent duplicates.
- IMPORT SET STAGING TABLE:**
Isolate Excel data in u_imp_* prior to transformation.
- AUTO-MAP MATCHING FIELDS:**
Rapidly align matching column headers to target schema.

2. STRATEGIC BETS (PHASE 2 FOCUS)

HIGH IMP • MED FEAS

- TRANSFORM SCRIPTS (ONBEFORE):**
Write JavaScript hooks to parse conflicting date strings and standardize phone numbers.
- REFERENCE FIELD VALUE MAPPING:**
Configure choice handling to populate Department sys_ids safely.

3. INCREMENTAL TASKS

MED IMP • HIGH FEAS

- TRANSFORM HISTORY LOG REVIEW:**
Run verification queries to inspect row-level error counts.
- TARGET TABLE SPOT-CHECK:**
Perform manual sampling of 10 created user profiles.

4. DEPRIORITIZE / DEFER

LOW IMP • LOW FEAS

- CUSTOM END-USER FILE UPLOAD PORTAL:**
Rely on native ServiceNow System Import Set interface rather than custom UI widgets.